EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY

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SUSTAINABILITY REPORT







8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

8.2 Employment practice



8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

ESSU Commitment to Employment Practice

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) is committed to providing fair, equitable, and competitive remuneration to its faculty members and administrative and support personnel through the implementation of the government's Salary Standardization Law (SSL), as provided under Executive Order No. 64, s. 2024. The issuance establishes an updated salary schedule for covered civilian government personnel, with compensation determined by salary grade and step. This framework recognizes differences in employees' duties, responsibilities, accountabilities, and qualification requirements while supporting a compensation system that is competitive and financially sustainable.

Through its adherence to the prescribed government compensation system, ESSU affirms its commitment to responsible employment practices and to recognizing the contributions of its workforce in fulfilling the University's mandate. For Indicator 8.2.1—Employment Practice: Living Wage, the University's salary schedule provides a basis for assessing employee compensation against the applicable local living-wage benchmark. Demonstrating that all faculty and staff receive at least a living wage requires supporting evidence, such as actual salary and payroll records and a documented comparison with the relevant benchmark.

8.2.1 Employment practice living wage

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its commitment to providing fair, equitable, and competitive remuneration to its faculty members and administrative and support personnel through the implementation of the government's Salary Standardization Law (SSL), as provided under Executive Order No. 64, s. 2024. This issuance authorizes an updated Salary Schedule for civilian government personnel, establishing standardized monthly compensation according to salary grades and corresponding steps. The compensation framework recognizes differences in employees' duties, responsibilities, accountabilities, and qualification requirements while ensuring that government compensation remains competitive and sustainable.

Under the updated salary schedule, **ESSU employees covered by the government compensation system receive salaries based on their respective position classifications and salary grades**. The adjustment is implemented in four tranches, beginning January 1, 2024, with subsequent adjustments scheduled through January 2027. The salary structure ranges from Salary Grade 1 to Salary Grade 33, with corresponding step increments that provide opportunities for salary progression. Furthermore, qualified government personnel are entitled to applicable benefits, including the medical allowance of up to ₱7,000 annually beginning FY 2025, subject to the prescribed guidelines.

For contractual and Job Order personnel, ESSU observes the applicable government rules on compensation, contract-based employment, and payment of services rendered. Their remuneration is determined by the terms of their respective contracts or job orders, the nature and duration of their assigned work, and the prescribed compensation rates. The University recognizes the contributions of these personnel to its academic, administrative, and operational functions and is committed to ensuring that their compensation is provided in accordance with applicable policies and employment arrangements.

Through these established compensation practices, ESSU upholds its commitment to responsible employment, employee welfare, and the recognition of the contributions of its entire workforce. The implementation of the SSL and the applicable compensation arrangements for contractual and Job Order personnel provides a basis for assessing whether employees receive remuneration that meets the living-wage benchmark applicable to Eastern Samar.

In relation to the living-wage requirement, the University's implementation of the SSL provides an established basis for evaluating employee compensation against the local poverty threshold for a family of four in Eastern Samar, expressed as an equivalent hourly wage. This comparison is essential in determining whether the lowest-paid faculty and staff members receive compensation that meets or exceeds the applicable local benchmark.

Link to Evidence:

Salary Standardization Law/EO No. 64, s. 2024

Implementation of the Second Tranche of the Updated Salary Schedule for Civilian Government Personnel Under Executive Order (EO) No. 64, s. 2024

Sample of Job Order and Contractual Employees Contracts

8.2.2 Employment practice unions: Recognition of Unions and Collective Bargaining

ESSU Commitment to Freedom of Association, Employee Representation, and Collective Bargaining

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes freedom of association, employee representation, and collective negotiation as essential elements of fair, inclusive, and participatory employment practices. The University upholds employees' rights to organize, elect their representatives, raise workplace concerns, and engage in constructive dialogue with management on matters affecting their rights, welfare, benefits, and working conditions.

This commitment is demonstrated through the **ESSU Faculty Federated Association**, led by its President, Dr. Delbert A. Dala, which advances the welfare and professional interests of faculty members across all campuses, and the **ESSU Employees Union (ESSU-EU),** which represents eligible rank-and-file employees through formal collective negotiations. These organizations provide mechanisms for employees to participate in discussions and negotiations concerning their employment conditions and professional welfare.

A significant manifestation of this commitment is the **Collective Negotiation Agreement (CNA) between ESSU Management and the ESSU-EU**, registered with the Civil Service Commission on May 6, 2024, under Certificate of Registration No. 3097. This formal recognition affirms the parties' commitment to good-faith negotiations and constructive labor-management relations. The CNA provides an established mechanism for addressing employee concerns and negotiating matters related to employment conditions, welfare, benefits, and workplace relations, consistent with applicable laws and government policies.

ESSU further upholds employees' right to elect their union leadership, as demonstrated by the re-election of Mr. Alfredo B. Cebricus as ESSU-EU President in May 2023. His priorities include advancing labor rights and employee benefits, promoting mental health and wellness, and strengthening collaboration with University Management. Beyond formal negotiations, the ESSU-EU, the Faculty Federated Association, and the Management Committee participate in employee-centered activities that promote solidarity, mutual respect, and cooperation across organizational levels and campuses.

The University's Human Resource Management Office (HRMO) also recognizes employee relations and the promotion of a supportive, inclusive workplace as important priorities in personnel management. In this regard, ESSU remains committed to ensuring that eligible employees, regardless of gender or other protected characteristics, have equitable access to applicable employee representation mechanisms, collective negotiation processes, and negotiated benefits in accordance with governing rules and the CNA.

Through its recognized employee organizations, registered CNA, and continuing labor-management engagement, ESSU demonstrates its commitment to protecting employees' rights to organize and participate in collective negotiations. These mechanisms affirm that employees are active partners in shaping a fair, responsive, and harmonious workplace and strengthen the University's commitment to inclusive employment practices across all campuses.

ESSU Initiatives and Measures

1. Institutional Recognition of Employee Organizations and Representation

ESSU recognizes the importance of organized employee representation through established associations and unions that advocate for the rights, welfare, and interests of its personnel.

- ***ESSU Faculty Federated Association*** – Serves as the umbrella organization of faculty associations established in each ESSU campus. It represents faculty members in matters concerning their employment rights, benefits, privileges, professional welfare, and other faculty-related concerns.
- ***Campus-Based Faculty Associations*** – Each ESSU campus maintains its respective faculty association, providing faculty members with an accessible mechanism for representation, consultation, and collective participation.
- ***ESSU Employees Union (ESSU-EU)*** – Serves as an organized employee representative body for university personnel, advocating for employee rights, benefits, privileges, welfare, and working conditions through the provisions of the Collective Negotiation Agreement.

2. Formal Recognition of the ESSU Employees Union and Collective Negotiation

- Recognition of the ESSU Employees Union as an organized employee representative body.

- Registration of the ESSU–ESSU Employees Union Collective Negotiation Agreement with the Civil Service Commission (CSC) on May 6, 2024.
- CSC Certificate of Registration No. 3097.
- Establishment of a formal mechanism for collective negotiation and labor-management dialogue.
- Recognition of the union's role in representing eligible employees in matters concerning employment conditions, benefits, and workplace welfare.

3. Democratic Union Leadership and Employee Representation

ESSU supports democratic employee representation by recognizing the right of personnel to elect their respective organizational leaders and representatives.

- Election of Mr. Alfredo Cebricus as ESSU Employees Union President on December 22, 2023.
- Promotion of employee participation in selecting union officers and representatives.
- Support for faculty associations in representing faculty interests at the campus and university levels.
- Encouragement of union leadership initiatives focusing on:
    - Protection of employee rights and privileges;
    - Advancement of employee benefits and welfare;
    - Promotion of mental health and workplace wellness; and
    - Strengthening collaboration between employee organizations and University management.

4. Implementation of the Collective Negotiation Agreement (CNA)

Through the registered CNA, ESSU provides a structured mechanism for collective negotiations between the University management and the recognized employees' union.

- Recognition of the union's negotiating role for eligible rank-and-file employees.
- Provision of a formal platform for discussing and negotiating:
    - Employment conditions and workplace policies;

- Employee benefits, rights, and privileges;
- Employee welfare and working conditions;
- Workplace concerns and grievances; and
- Labor-management relations.

- Implementation of applicable CNA provisions and negotiated benefits in accordance with government regulations.
- Promotion of transparency, consultation, and constructive engagement between management and employee representatives.

5. Promotion of Inclusive Employee Organizations and Workplace Solidarity

ESSU encourages collaboration among its employee organizations and management to strengthen workplace relationships and institutional solidarity.

- Engagement of the ESSU Faculty Federated Association, campus-based faculty associations, ESSU Employees Union, and Management Committee in employee-centered activities.
- Organization and participation in university-wide activities that promote:
  - Employee camaraderie and collaboration;
  - Mental health and wellness;
  - Mutual respect among personnel;
  - Cooperation across organizational levels and campuses; and
  - Shared responsibility for institutional development.

6. Equal Access to Union Representation and Employee Participation

ESSU upholds nondiscriminatory employment practices and respects employees' freedom to associate and participate in recognized representation mechanisms.

- Promotion of equal opportunities for faculty and administrative personnel to participate in their respective employee organizations.
- Recognition of women's participation and representation in employee associations, union leadership, and consultations.

- Respect for the applicable rights of employees regardless of gender or nationality, including international personnel, subject to relevant civil service rules and eligibility requirements.
- Promotion of employee welfare and representation as integral components of institutional governance.

ESSU EMPLOYEE WELFARE, WELLNESS, AND UNION-LED ACTIVITIES


Campus

EASTERN SAMAR STATE U SETS UP OWN COMMUNITY PANTRY FOR EMPLOYEES

DANIEL ASIDO / 16 MAY 2021

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its commitment to employee welfare and inclusive employment practices through the establishment of its own **Community Pantry for Employees, an institutional initiative that promotes solidarity, mutual support, and concern for the well-being of its workforce.** This initiative reflects the University's recognition that employee welfare extends beyond employment benefits and formal workplace policies, encompassing access to basic necessities and a supportive working environment. By providing a platform for sharing resources and extending assistance among personnel, the initiative strengthens employee engagement, camaraderie, and a culture of compassion within the University community. It complements ESSU's commitment under Indicator 8.2 – Employment Practice: Unions by reinforcing its broader institutional efforts to uphold employee welfare, promote workplace solidarity, and foster an inclusive and supportive environment for all employees.

Link to Evidence: Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Sets Up Own Community Pantry for Employees



Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) promotes employee welfare, wellness, and gender equality through its participation in the National Women's Month celebration, highlighted by the Zumba activity held on March 19, 2026, at the University Grandstand. Organized in collaboration with the Gender and Development (GAD) Office, the activity encourages physical fitness, mental well-being, camaraderie, and women's empowerment, with sessions continuing every Thursday throughout March. This initiative reflects ESSU's commitment to fostering a healthy, inclusive, and supportive workplace where employees are encouraged to prioritize their well-being and participate in activities that promote gender equality and workplace solidarity.

Link to Evidence: ESSU Hypes Up the Energy for Women's Month Zumba

Link to Other Evidence:

CSC Certificate of Registration of the ESSU–ESSU Employees Union Collective Negotiation Agreement (CNA), dated May 6, 2024

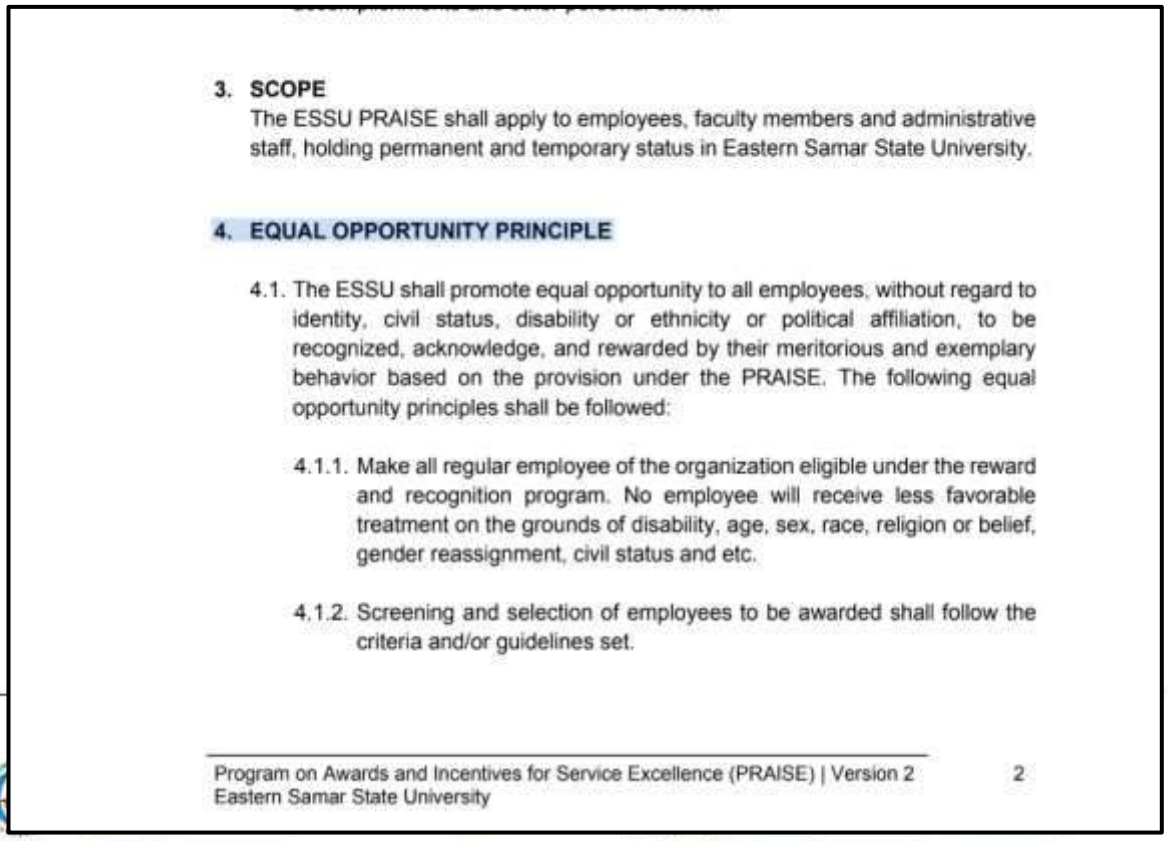
ESSU Employees Union Officers and Organizational Structure

ESSU Faculty Federated Association Officers and Organizational Structure

8.2.3 Employment policy on discrimination

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) upholds the principles of equality, inclusivity, fairness, and respect for human dignity through institutional policies and mechanisms that promote a workplace free from discrimination. **The University's commitment to non-discriminatory employment practices is embedded in its approved Program on Awards and Incentives for Service Excellence (PRAISE) Manual, Strategic Performance Management System (SPMS), Merit Selection Plan (MSP) for Administrative Personnel, and Learning and Development (L&D) policies for both faculty and administrative employees**. These institutional frameworks promote equitable opportunities in employee recruitment, selection, performance evaluation, recognition, career advancement, professional development, and access to institutional benefits. Through merit-based personnel systems, transparent performance assessment, and inclusive capacity-building initiatives, ESSU endeavors to ensure that employees are treated fairly and without discrimination based on religion, sex, gender, sexual orientation, age, or other personal circumstances, consistent with applicable laws and civil service regulations. By institutionalizing these policies, ESSU reinforces its commitment to providing a respectful, equitable, and inclusive working environment where every employee is valued, empowered, and given equal opportunities to contribute to the University's mission and organizational development.

1. Approved ESSU PRAISE Manual. Page 2



3. **SCOPE**
The ESSU PRAISE shall apply to employees, faculty members and administrative staff, holding permanent and temporary status in Eastern Samar State University.

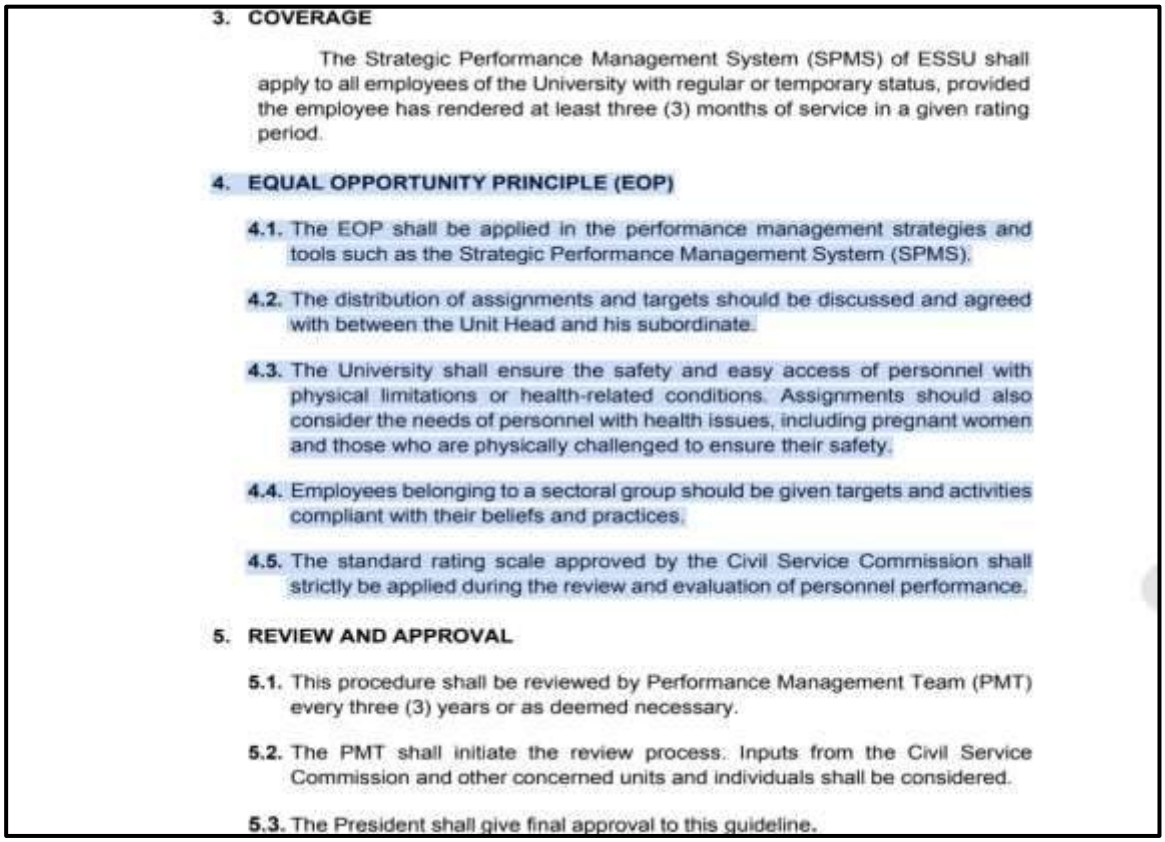
4. **EQUAL OPPORTUNITY PRINCIPLE**

4.1. The ESSU shall promote equal opportunity to all employees, without regard to identity, civil status, disability or ethnicity or political affiliation, to be recognized, acknowledge, and rewarded by their meritorious and exemplary behavior based on the provision under the PRAISE. The following equal opportunity principles shall be followed:

4.1.1. Make all regular employee of the organization eligible under the reward and recognition program. No employee will receive less favorable treatment on the grounds of disability, age, sex, race, religion or belief, gender reassignment, civil status and etc.

4.1.2. Screening and selection of employees to be awarded shall follow the criteria and/or guidelines set.

2. Approved ESSU Strategic Performance Management System (SPMS).Page 3



3. COVERAGE

The Strategic Performance Management System (SPMS) of ESSU shall apply to all employees of the University with regular or temporary status, provided the employee has rendered at least three (3) months of service in a given rating period.

4. EQUAL OPPORTUNITY PRINCIPLE (EOP)

4.1. The EOP shall be applied in the performance management strategies and tools such as the Strategic Performance Management System (SPMS).

4.2. The distribution of assignments and targets should be discussed and agreed with between the Unit Head and his subordinate.

4.3. The University shall ensure the safety and easy access of personnel with physical limitations or health-related conditions. Assignments should also consider the needs of personnel with health issues, including pregnant women and those who are physically challenged to ensure their safety.

4.4. Employees belonging to a sectoral group should be given targets and activities compliant with their beliefs and practices.

4.5. The standard rating scale approved by the Civil Service Commission shall strictly be applied during the review and evaluation of personnel performance.

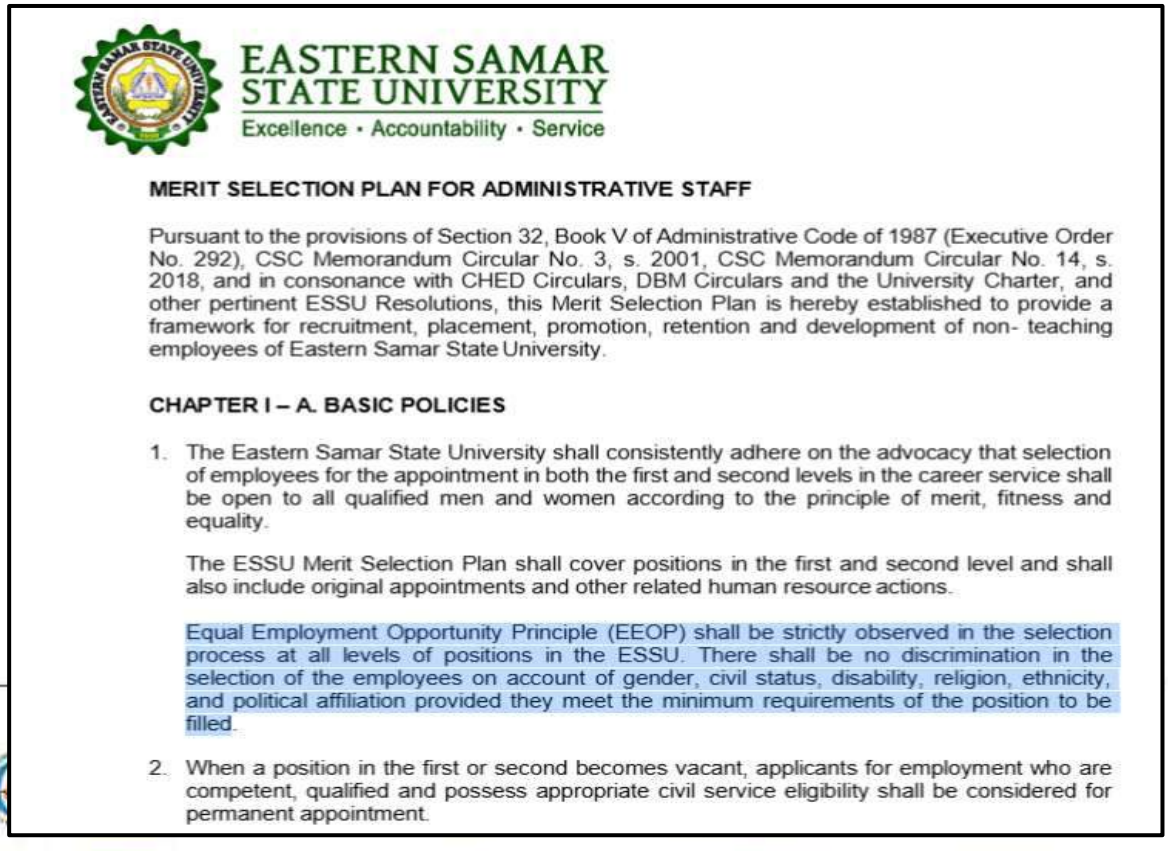
5. REVIEW AND APPROVAL

5.1. This procedure shall be reviewed by Performance Management Team (PMT) every three (3) years or as deemed necessary.

5.2. The PMT shall initiate the review process. Inputs from the Civil Service Commission and other concerned units and individuals shall be considered.

5.3. The President shall give final approval to this guideline.

3. Approved Merit Selection Plan (MSP) for Administrative Personnel. Page 1



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MERIT SELECTION PLAN FOR ADMINISTRATIVE STAFF

Pursuant to the provisions of Section 32, Book V of Administrative Code of 1987 (Executive Order No. 292), CSC Memorandum Circular No. 3, s. 2001, CSC Memorandum Circular No. 14, s. 2018, and in consonance with CHED Circulars, DBM Circulars and the University Charter, and other pertinent ESSU Resolutions, this Merit Selection Plan is hereby established to provide a framework for recruitment, placement, promotion, retention and development of non- teaching employees of Eastern Samar State University.

CHAPTER I – A. BASIC POLICIES

1. The Eastern Samar State University shall consistently adhere on the advocacy that selection of employees for the appointment in both the first and second levels in the career service shall be open to all qualified men and women according to the principle of merit, fitness and equality.

   The ESSU Merit Selection Plan shall cover positions in the first and second level and shall also include original appointments and other related human resource actions.

   Equal Employment Opportunity Principle (EEOP) shall be strictly observed in the selection process at all levels of positions in the ESSU. There shall be no discrimination in the selection of the employees on account of gender, civil status, disability, religion, ethnicity, and political affiliation provided they meet the minimum requirements of the position to be filled.

2. When a position in the first or second becomes vacant, applicants for employment who are competent, qualified and possess appropriate civil service eligibility shall be considered for permanent appointment.

4. Approved Learning and Development Plan for Faculty Members. Page 8-9

VI. EQUAL OPPORTUNITY PRINCIPLE (EOP)

ESSU's Learning and Development Policy for Teaching Personnel adheres to the Equal Opportunity Principle (EOP) and strictly observe no discrimination in providing learning interventions for officials and employees on account of age, race, religious belief, political affiliation, physical disability, ethnic or social origin, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression (SOGIE).

1. The EOP shall be observed in the learning and development of personnel.

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2. All personnel, regardless of sex, sexual orientation and gender identity, civil status, disability, religion, ethnicity, or political affiliation, shall be given equal chances to pursue advanced degrees as long as it is in line with his planned field of specialization and also, in attendance of training, seminar, workshops, conferences, fora, etc.

3. Personnel who can no longer secure external scholarship to pursue formal degrees due to age and other disabilities, shall be provided university scholarships subject to compliance with the provisions of the Faculty Development Plan and the policies against in-breeding. The scholarship will provide the same privileges and benefits given to other ESSU scholarship grantees.

4. When a differently-abled personnel is recommended to attend local training and seminar workshops, another personnel shall likewise be recommended and allowed to attend similar training to act as his/her buddy during the travel to and from the venue of the said training/seminar workshop to assist and provide necessary support to the personnel, when necessary.

5. Approved Learning and Development Plan for Administrative Personnel. Page 10

VI. EQUAL OPPORTUNITY PRINCIPLE (EOP)

ESSU's Learning and Development Policy for Teaching Personnel adheres to the Equal Opportunity Principle (EOP) and strictly observe no discrimination in providing learning interventions for officials and employees on account of age, race, religious belief, political affiliation, physical disability, ethnic or social origin, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression (SOGIE).

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2. All personnel, regardless of sex, sexual orientation and gender identity, civil status, disability, religion, ethnicity, or political affiliation, shall be given equal chances to pursue advanced degrees as long as it is in line with his planned field of specialization and also, in attendance of training, seminar, workshops, conferences, fora, etc.

3. Personnel who can no longer secure external scholarship to pursue formal degrees due to age and other disabilities, shall be provided university scholarships subject to compliance with the provisions of the Personnel Development Plan and the policies against in-breeding. The scholarship will provide the same privileges and benefits given to other ESSU scholarship grantees.

4. When a differently-abled personnel is recommended to attend local training and seminar workshops, another personnel shall likewise be recommended and allowed to attend similar training to act as his/her buddy during the travel to and from the venue of the said training/seminar workshop to assist and provide necessary support to the personnel, when necessary.

8.2.4 – Employment Policy on Modern Slavery

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) upholds the principles of human dignity, social justice, ethical employment, and the protection of fundamental human rights through its commitment to maintaining a workplace free from forced labour, modern slavery, human trafficking, child labour, and all forms of labour exploitation. Guided by applicable national labour laws, civil service regulations, and human rights standards, the University promotes fair, voluntary, lawful, and non-discriminatory employment practices that safeguard employees against coercion, abuse, exploitation, and other labour-related violations.

This institutional commitment is operationalized through ESSU's human resource policies and mechanisms, including the approved Merit Selection Plan (MSP), Program on Awards and Incentives for Service Excellence (PRAISE) Manual, Strategic Performance Management System (SPMS), and Learning and Development policies for faculty and administrative personnel. These mechanisms reinforce transparent recruitment, merit-based selection, equitable treatment, performance accountability, employee recognition, professional development, and the protection of employee rights and welfare. The University likewise observes applicable age, qualification, and employment requirements in personnel recruitment and engagement. Through responsible human resource management, employee awareness and development, grievance and reporting mechanisms, and institutional accountability, ESSU strengthens its safeguards against coercive, discriminatory, and exploitative employment practices and promotes a safe, ethical, inclusive, and rights-respecting working environment across all its campuses.

The corresponding supporting documents are accessible through the embedded hyperlinks provided in the table below.

ESSU Approved Plans	What it demonstrates	Focus
Merit Selection Plan (MSP) • Faculty • Administrative	Merit-based, transparent, and non-discriminatory recruitment and selection	Recruitment safeguards
PRAISE Manual	Equitable recognition, rewards, incentives, and employee welfare	Fair treatment and employee dignity

Strategic Performance Management System (SPMS)	Transparent performance assessment, accountability, and fair performance management	Ethical employment practices
Learning and Development Policies • Faculty • Administrative	Employee awareness, capacity building, professional growth, and development opportunities	Prevention through education and awareness
Grievance Machinery / HR policies	Reporting, investigation, and resolution of employee complaints	Protection and accountability

8.2.5 – Employment Practice: Equivalent Rights in Outsourcing

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes that its commitment to fair, ethical, inclusive, and socially responsible employment practices extends beyond its directly employed personnel to include workers engaged through third-party service providers and outsourced arrangements. The University upholds the principle that all individuals performing essential services within its campuses deserve respect, dignity, fair treatment, and appropriate protection of their rights, regardless of their employment arrangement or contractual status. Guided by applicable Philippine labour laws, government procurement regulations, and occupational safety and health standards, ESSU promotes the observance of statutory wages, mandatory benefits, lawful working conditions, workplace safety, and protection against discrimination, exploitation, and unfair treatment among outsourced personnel.

This commitment is integrated into the University's procurement, contracting, and contract management processes for outsourced services, including security, janitorial, maintenance, and other operational support services. Through the engagement of legitimate service providers, observance of procurement and labour compliance requirements, inclusion of appropriate contractual obligations, and monitoring of contractor performance, ESSU reinforces the expectation that third-party providers uphold applicable employment standards and protect the welfare of their workers. The University likewise promotes occupational safety and health within its premises, coordinates with service providers on personnel-related concerns, and encourages respectful and inclusive interactions among regular employees, contractual personnel, and outsourced workers. Through these institutional measures, ESSU advances responsible outsourcing and affirms its commitment to promoting equivalent protection of fundamental labour rights, decent working conditions, and a safe, equitable, and dignified working environment across all its campuses.

ESSU Initiatives and Measures

The following initiatives demonstrate ESSU's commitment to equivalent rights for outsourced workers:

1. Compliance with Labour Standards in Outsourced Services

- Engagement of legitimate third-party service providers for janitorial, security, maintenance, and other support services.
- Promotion of compliance with applicable Philippine labour laws, including statutory wages, benefits, and other mandatory employment entitlements.

- Recognition of workers' rights regardless of whether they are directly employed or engaged through service contractors.

2. Integration of Labour Compliance Requirements in Procurement and Contracting

- Observance of government procurement policies and applicable labour standards in the selection and engagement of service providers.
- Inclusion of relevant contractual provisions requiring service providers to comply with labour laws and employment regulations.
- Verification of required business permits, licenses, and other relevant documentary requirements of contractors.

3. Protection of Outsourced Workers' Welfare and Safety

- Promotion of occupational safety and health standards among outsourced personnel working within ESSU premises.
- Coordination with service providers concerning workers' safety, workplace conditions, and operational concerns.
- Encouragement of fair and respectful treatment of outsourced workers by university personnel and stakeholders.

4. Monitoring and Accountability of Third-Party Service Providers

- Monitoring of contractors' compliance with contractual obligations and applicable labour requirements.
- Coordination with service providers regarding concerns affecting their personnel.
- Implementation of appropriate contract monitoring and performance evaluation mechanisms.

5. Promotion of Inclusive and Dignified Workplace Practices

- Recognition of outsourced workers as important contributors to the University's daily operations and delivery of public services.
- Promotion of a respectful and discrimination-free working environment for all personnel within ESSU premises.
- Encouragement of cooperation and mutual respect among regular employees, contractual personnel, and outsourced workers.

8.2.6 Employment policy pay scale equity

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes equitable employment practices as an essential component of institutional governance, employee welfare, and sustainable economic development. Consistent with Sustainable Development Goal 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth), the University upholds the principles of merit, fitness, equality, nondiscrimination, and fairness in employment, personnel selection, career advancement, and compensation. These principles are reflected in its institutional human resource policies and are supported by national laws and government compensation regulations governing public sector employment.

The University's commitment to employment equity is anchored in the approved Merit Selection Plans (MSPs) for Administrative Staff and Faculty Members, which establish the institutional framework for recruitment, selection, promotion, and other personnel actions. These plans were approved by the Civil Service Commission Regional Office VIII in October and November 2021, respectively. Both MSPs institutionalize the principle that personnel decisions must be based on merit, qualifications, competence, fitness, and equality, while ensuring that qualified applicants and employees are afforded fair and nondiscriminatory treatment.

Institutional Policy Framework on Employment Equity

The approved Merit Selection Plan for Administrative Staff explicitly establishes ESSU's commitment to equal employment opportunity and nondiscrimination. On page 1, it provides:

"The Eastern Samar State University shall consistently adhere on the advocacy that selection of employees for the appointment in both the first and second levels in the career service shall be open to all qualified men and women according to the principle of merit, fitness and equality."

The same page further states:

"Equal Employment Opportunity Principle (EEOP) shall be strictly observed in the selection process at all levels of positions in the ESSU. There shall be no discrimination in the selection of the employees on account of gender, civil status, disability, religion, ethnicity, and political affiliation provided they meet the minimum requirements of the position to be filled."

These provisions establish the University's commitment to merit-based personnel management and equal opportunity in employment. They ensure that selection and appointment decisions are governed by objective qualifications and position requirements rather than discriminatory considerations.

The Administrative MSP further reinforces this commitment on page 4:

"The University shall adhere to the principle of providing equal employment opportunities to qualified Filipino citizens. It shall employ its human resources on the basis of merit, fitness, competence and equality."

It also explicitly provides:

"All RSP actions shall be made without discrimination on the account of age, sex, sexual orientation and gender identity, civil status, religion, ethnicity or political affiliation."

These provisions extend the University's nondiscrimination commitment across recruitment, selection, and personnel actions, including promotion and other career advancement opportunities.

The Merit Selection Plan for Faculty Members similarly incorporates employment equity into faculty recruitment and personnel management. On page 1, it emphasizes:

"Adherence to the principles of quality service, merit and fitness, equality and that selection of employees shall be based on their relative qualifications, competence, and character to perform the duties and responsibilities of the position;"

On page 2, the Faculty MSP explicitly provides:

"Compliance of the equal employment opportunity principle, that is, there shall be no discrimination in the selection of employees on account of age, sex, sexual orientation and gender identity, civil status, disability, religion, ethnicity, or political affiliation;"

These provisions demonstrate that ESSU's employment equity principles apply to both administrative and academic personnel, ensuring that employment decisions are guided by fairness, competence, and equal opportunity.

Legal Foundations of Equitable Compensation and Pay Scale Equity

ESSU's employment and compensation practices are implemented within the framework of applicable Philippine laws and government compensation policies. These legal instruments provide the basis for fair compensation, nondiscriminatory treatment, and equitable employment conditions in public institutions.

Republic Act No. 11466, or the Salary Standardization Law of 2019, provides the statutory basis for the implementation of the modified salary schedule for government personnel. This framework supports standardized compensation structures and salary grade allocations within the public sector.

Executive Order No. 64, series of 2024, further provides for the implementation of the updated salary schedule and benefits for civilian government personnel, reinforcing the government's commitment to an equitable and standardized compensation system.

Republic Act No. 6725, which strengthens the prohibition against discrimination against women with respect to terms and conditions of employment, including compensation, reinforces the principle that women must not be subjected to lower compensation for work of equal value. This principle is also reflected in the relevant provisions of the Labor Code of the Philippines, particularly Article 135, as amended, which prohibits discrimination against women in employment and compensation.

Republic Act No. 9710, or the Magna Carta of Women, further strengthens the national policy framework for gender equality and women's economic empowerment. It recognizes the importance of equal opportunities, nondiscrimination, and equitable participation in employment and professional advancement.

Taken together, these legal provisions establish a national policy environment supporting equitable employment practices and fair compensation. ESSU's approved Merit Selection Plans complement this framework by institutionalizing merit-based personnel management, equal employment opportunity, and nondiscriminatory recruitment and career advancement.

Institutional Provisions Supporting Equitable Compensation and Career Advancement

The approved MSPs contain provisions that support fair employment conditions and equitable personnel treatment.

The Administrative MSP, page 4, states:

"A qualified employee with disability shall be subject to the same terms and conditions of employment and the same compensation, privileges, benefits, fringe benefits, incentives or allowances as a qualified able bodied person."

The Faculty MSP, page 22, contains the corresponding provision:

"A qualified employee with disability shall be subject to the same terms and conditions of employment and the same compensation, privileges, benefits, fringe benefits, incentives or allowances as a qualified able bodied person."

These provisions demonstrate ESSU's institutional commitment to equality in employment conditions and compensation-related entitlements, particularly for qualified employees with disabilities.

The Administrative MSP also provides on page 4:

"Publication of vacancy announcements shall clearly indicate that diverse and qualified applicants are encouraged to apply for the vacant position as long as the applicant can perform the functions required of the position. It shall not publish announcements that will suggest preferences, limitations and specifications as regards to gender identity, civil status, religion, ethnicity or political affiliation."

This provision supports inclusive recruitment and equal access to employment opportunities.

Furthermore, the Faculty MSP, page 2, provides:

"A faculty member may be considered for promotion to a higher faculty rank/sub-rank on the basis of the minimum requirements (education, training and scholarship grants) of the position, including performance rating of at least Very Satisfactory during the last two (2) rating periods;"

This provision demonstrates that faculty career advancement is governed by established qualifications and performance standards. Similarly, the Administrative MSP, page 2, establishes a salary-grade limitation for promotion, reinforcing the application of structured personnel and compensation arrangements within the University.

Summary of Approved Merit Selection Plan Provisions Relevant to Employment Equity

The following table presents the actual provisions of ESSU's approved Merit Selection Plans that support employment equity, nondiscrimination, and equitable treatment.

Employment Equity Area	Approved Administrative MSP	Approved Faculty MSP
Merit, fitness, and equality	Page 1: "The Eastern Samar State University shall consistently adhere on the advocacy that selection of employees for the appointment in both the first and second levels in the career service shall be open to all qualified men and women according to the principle of merit, fitness and equality."	Page 1: "Adherence to the principles of quality service, merit and fitness, equality and that selection of employees shall be based on their relative qualifications, competence, and character to perform the duties and responsibilities of the position;"
Equal employment opportunity	Page 1: "Equal Employment Opportunity Principle (EEOP) shall be strictly observed in the selection process at all levels of positions in the ESSU."	Page 2: "Compliance of the equal employment opportunity principle, that is, there shall be no discrimination in the selection of employees on account of age, sex, sexual orientation and gender identity, civil status, disability, religion, ethnicity, or political affiliation;"
Nondiscrimination in personnel actions	Page 4: "All RSP actions shall be made without discrimination on the account of age, sex, sexual orientation and gender identity, civil status, religion,	Page 21: "All RSP actions shall be made without discrimination on the account of age, sex, sexual orientation and gender identity, civil status, religion,

	ethnicity or political affiliation."	ethnicity or political affiliation."
Equal employment opportunities	Page 4: "The University shall adhere to the principle of providing equal employment opportunities to qualified Filipino citizens. It shall employ its human resources on the basis of merit, fitness, competence and equality."	Page 21: "The University shall adhere to the principle of providing equal employment opportunities to qualified Filipino citizens. It shall employ its human resources on the basis of merit, fitness, competence and equality."
Equal compensation and employment conditions for qualified persons with disabilities	Page 4: "A qualified employee with disability shall be subject to the same terms and conditions of employment and the same compensation, privileges, benefits, fringe benefits, incentives or allowances as a qualified able bodied person."	Page 22: "A qualified employee with disability shall be subject to the same terms and conditions of employment and the same compensation, privileges, benefits, fringe benefits, incentives or allowances as a qualified able bodied person."
Inclusive recruitment	Page 4: "Publication of vacancy announcements shall clearly indicate that diverse and qualified applicants are encouraged to apply for the vacant position as long as the applicant can perform the functions required of the position."	Page 14: The MSP provides that the University President shall, as far as practicable, ensure equal employment opportunity in appointing faculty for all levels of positions.
Merit-based promotion and career advancement	Page 2: "An employee may be promoted to a position which is not more than three (3) salary grade, pay or job grades higher than the	Page 2: "A faculty member may be considered for promotion to a higher faculty rank/sub-rank on the basis of the minimum requirements

	employee's present position."	(education, training and scholarship grants) of the position, including performance rating of at least Very Satisfactory during the last two (2) rating periods;"

Continuing Policy Review and Enhancement of Employment Equity

Eastern Samar State University recognizes that equitable employment practices require continuous policy enhancement to respond to evolving statutory requirements, institutional priorities, and emerging standards of workplace equality. While the University's approved Merit Selection Plans for Administrative Staff and Faculty Members establish an institutional foundation for merit-based personnel management, equal employment opportunity, and nondiscriminatory employment practices, ESSU also recognizes the importance of further strengthening its policy framework on compensation equity.

In this regard, the University is currently reviewing a proposal for the updating of its Merit Selection Plans. This ongoing policy review seeks to further enhance the alignment of ESSU's human resource policies with applicable national laws, government compensation policies, institutional development priorities, and contemporary principles of equitable employment.

The proposed updating presents an opportunity to reinforce the University's existing commitments to merit-based personnel management, nondiscrimination, equitable compensation, and fair career advancement. It also provides an avenue for strengthening explicit institutional provisions on pay scale equity, particularly the commitment to the systematic measurement and elimination of gender pay gaps.

Although the existing MSPs establish important principles of equality and nondiscrimination, they do not expressly articulate a specific institutional commitment to measuring and eliminating gender pay gaps. Consequently, ESSU recognizes the importance of further developing its policy framework to explicitly address gender pay equity and to complement its existing employment equity provisions with appropriate institutional mechanisms.

The ongoing review of the proposed MSP updates reflects ESSU's continuing commitment to policy improvement and responsible institutional governance. Through this

initiative, the University seeks to ensure that its employment policies remain responsive, relevant, and supportive of an equitable and inclusive workplace. The review also demonstrates ESSU's forward-looking approach to strengthening its institutional framework for decent work, fair employment practices, and sustainable human resource development.

Institutional Commitment to SDG 8

ESSU's employment equity framework contributes to the University's broader commitment to Sustainable Development Goal 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth. Through its approved Merit Selection Plans, compliance with applicable national laws, and continuing policy review initiatives, the University promotes merit-based employment, equal opportunity, nondiscriminatory personnel management, and fair treatment of employees.

These institutional commitments support the principles underlying SDG Target 8.5, which promotes full and productive employment, decent work, and equal pay for work of equal value. They also contribute to the broader objectives of SDG 8 concerning inclusive employment practices, protection of workers, and equitable workplace conditions.

The University's ongoing policy review further reinforces its recognition that employment equity is a continuing institutional responsibility. By strengthening its human resource policy framework and pursuing more explicit provisions on pay scale equity and gender pay gap measurement, ESSU seeks to advance a workplace environment characterized by fairness, inclusivity, accountability, and respect for the rights and dignity of all employees.

Through these institutional measures, Eastern Samar State University demonstrates its commitment to strengthening employment practices and advancing the principles of decent work and sustainable economic growth.

Link to Evidence:

Approved Merit Selection Plan for Faculty

Approved Merit Selection Plan for Administrative

8.2.7 Tracking Pay Scale for Gender Equity

Personnel data as of December 31, 2025

895	420	475
Total permanent personnel	Male personnel: **46.9%**	Female personnel: **51.1%**

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes that equitable employment practices extend beyond providing equal access to employment opportunities. They also require institutional mechanisms for monitoring personnel distribution, promoting fairness in compensation, and ensuring that employees are treated equitably regardless of gender. Consistent with Sustainable Development Goal 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth, the University considers the systematic tracking of personnel across salary grades an important component of its commitment to employment equity and fair compensation practices.

In support of this commitment, ESSU maintains sex-disaggregated personnel data showing the distribution of permanent male and female employees across salary grades in its five campuses: Main Campus, Salcedo Campus, Guiuan Campus, Maydolong Campus, and Can-avid Campus. The data, recorded as of December 31, 2025, provide an institutional reference for examining gender representation within the University's salary structure and monitoring the distribution of employees across different levels of compensation.

The University's tracking measure is aligned with the objective of THE Sustainability Impact Ratings 2027 under Metric 8.2.7, **Tracking Pay Scale for Gender Equity**, which assesses the existence of measures, the evidence provided, and whether the evidence is publicly available. By maintaining personnel records disaggregated by sex and salary grade, ESSU establishes a basis for examining gender representation across its compensation structure and identifying areas that may warrant further assessment.

Gender Distribution of Permanent Personnel Across ESSU Campuses

As of December 31, 2025, ESSU recorded a total of **895 permanent personnel** across its five campuses. Of this number, **420 (46.93%)** were male and **475 (53.07%)** were female. The figures indicate that women constitute a slightly larger proportion of the University's permanent workforce, representing approximately 53.1% of the total, compared with 46.9% for men.

This distribution demonstrates the substantial participation of women in ESSU's permanent workforce and provides a baseline for monitoring gender representation in the University's personnel structure. The relatively balanced overall distribution indicates that both male and female employees are significantly represented in the institution's permanent employment complement.

The campus-level figures further provide a more detailed perspective on gender representation across the University's organizational units. The Main Campus accounts for the largest number of permanent employees, with 452 personnel, comprising 217 male and 235 female employees. Salcedo Campus has 154 permanent personnel, consisting of 73 male and 81 female employees, while Guiuan Campus has 134, comprising 63 male and 71 female employees. Maydolong Campus records 75 permanent employees, with 34 male and 41 female employees. Can-avid Campus has 80 permanent personnel, consisting of 33 male and 47 female employees.

Across all five campuses, female personnel outnumber male personnel. The difference is most pronounced in Can-avid Campus, where women account for 58.75% of permanent personnel, followed by Maydolong Campus at 54.67%. The Main, Salcedo, and Guiuan Campuses also demonstrate relatively balanced gender representation, with female personnel comprising approximately 52% to 53% of their respective permanent workforces.

These figures provide ESSU with a consolidated institutional baseline for monitoring the participation of men and women in permanent employment across its campuses. They also allow the University to identify campus-level differences in workforce composition and provide a reference for subsequent personnel monitoring and gender-responsive human resource planning.

Distribution of Personnel by Gender and Salary Grade

Beyond the overall number of male and female employees, ESSU's tracking measure organizes permanent personnel according to their respective salary grades. This is significant because examining gender representation across salary grades provides a more meaningful basis for assessing employment equity than considering the total workforce distribution alone.

The salary-grade classification allows the University to examine whether male and female employees are represented across the different levels of its compensation structure. It also provides a basis for identifying salary grades where one gender may be disproportionately represented and for determining whether further examination of recruitment, promotion, career progression, and compensation practices is necessary.

Through this approach, ESSU moves beyond simply counting the number of male and female employees and establishes a more structured method of monitoring their distribution within the University's personnel and compensation system. The resulting information can support evidence-based human resource decisions, particularly in reviewing opportunities for career advancement and ensuring that personnel policies are consistently implemented.

The use of salary grades as a monitoring category is also relevant to the University's implementation of government compensation policies, including the Salary Standardization Law and subsequent issuances governing the compensation of civilian government personnel. Since government positions are assigned corresponding salary grades and salary schedules, the classification provides a common reference for examining the distribution of permanent employees across compensation levels.

Institutional Interpretation and Significance of the Data

The December 31, 2025 personnel data demonstrate three important institutional outcomes.

First, **ESSU has established a sex-disaggregated personnel tracking measure across its five campuses.** The consolidated records identify the number of male and female permanent employees and classify them according to salary grade. This provides an institutional basis for monitoring gender representation within the University's workforce and compensation structure.

Second, the **data support a more systematic examination of gender representation across salary levels.** By organizing personnel according to salary grade, ESSU can examine whether women and men are represented across different levels of the University's employment structure. Such information can help identify possible disparities in representation and provide a basis for further investigation into the factors affecting career progression and access to higher-level positions.

Third, the **consolidated information strengthens institutional planning and evidence-based human resource management.** The availability of campus-level and salary-grade information allows the University to establish a baseline for subsequent monitoring, compare personnel distribution across campuses, and inform future gender-responsive employment and personnel development initiatives.

It is important to emphasize that the figures represent the number of male and female permanent employees within each salary grade, rather than individual salary amounts or average compensation by gender. Consequently, the data should be interpreted as evidence of gender-disaggregated tracking across salary grades and not, on their own, as proof that a gender pay gap exists or has been eliminated. Further analysis of actual compensation, position classification, employment status, and comparable work would be necessary to determine whether differences in pay exist between male and female employees performing work of equal value.

Nevertheless, maintaining these records is an important institutional measure because it provides the information needed to examine gender representation within the compensation structure and to identify areas requiring further assessment. It establishes a foundation for more comprehensive gender pay equity monitoring and strengthens the University's capacity to make informed and responsive human resource decisions.

Contribution to SDG 8 and Institutional Commitment to Gender Equity

ESSU's tracking of permanent personnel by gender and salary grade contributes to the broader objectives of Sustainable Development Goal 8, particularly the promotion of decent work, productive employment, and equal pay for work of equal value under Target 8.5. The systematic monitoring of personnel distribution supports the University's efforts to promote fair employment practices and strengthen institutional accountability in managing its human resources.

The University's sex-disaggregated personnel records also provide a practical basis for strengthening gender-responsive employment policies. By examining the representation of

male and female employees across salary grades, ESSU can identify areas for further review and develop appropriate interventions to support equitable career opportunities and compensation practices.

Moving forward, ESSU can further strengthen this measure by conducting periodic gender pay equity assessments using actual compensation data, comparable positions, salary grades, and relevant employment characteristics. Such assessments would allow the University to move from monitoring workforce distribution to more directly evaluating possible gender pay differences and identifying appropriate measures to address any unjustified disparities.

Through the maintenance and analysis of sex-disaggregated personnel records, ESSU demonstrates its commitment to evidence-based human resource management, equal employment opportunity, and the continuous improvement of its employment practices. These efforts reinforce the University's responsibility to promote an inclusive workplace where all employees are afforded fair opportunities for professional development, career advancement, and equitable compensation.

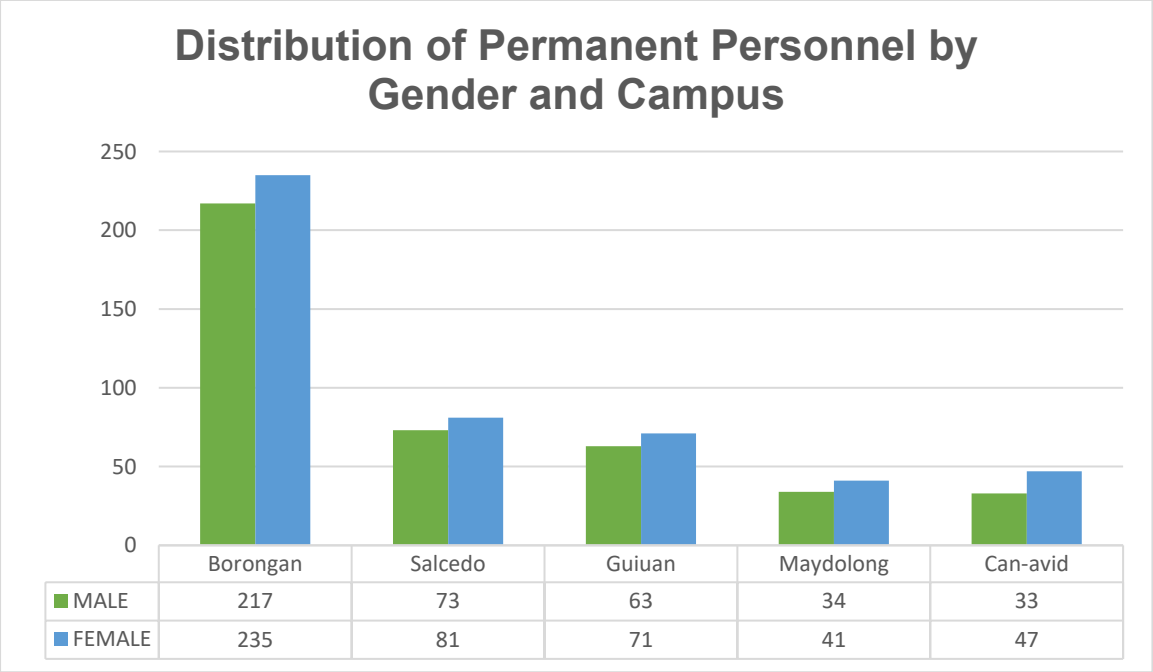
Ultimately, the University's tracking of personnel by gender and salary grade serves as an institutional mechanism for monitoring employment equity and supporting the principles of decent work and sustainable economic growth. It provides a measurable baseline for assessing gender representation across the University's compensation structure and a foundation for strengthening its commitment to pay scale equity.

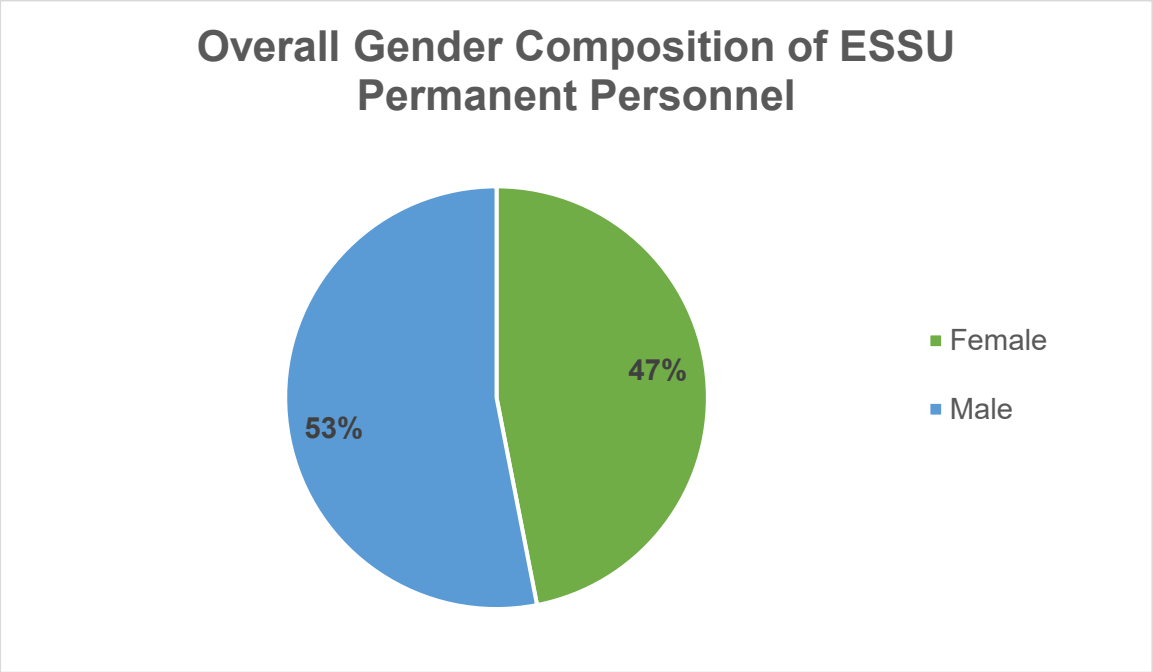
I. Consolidated Personnel Data

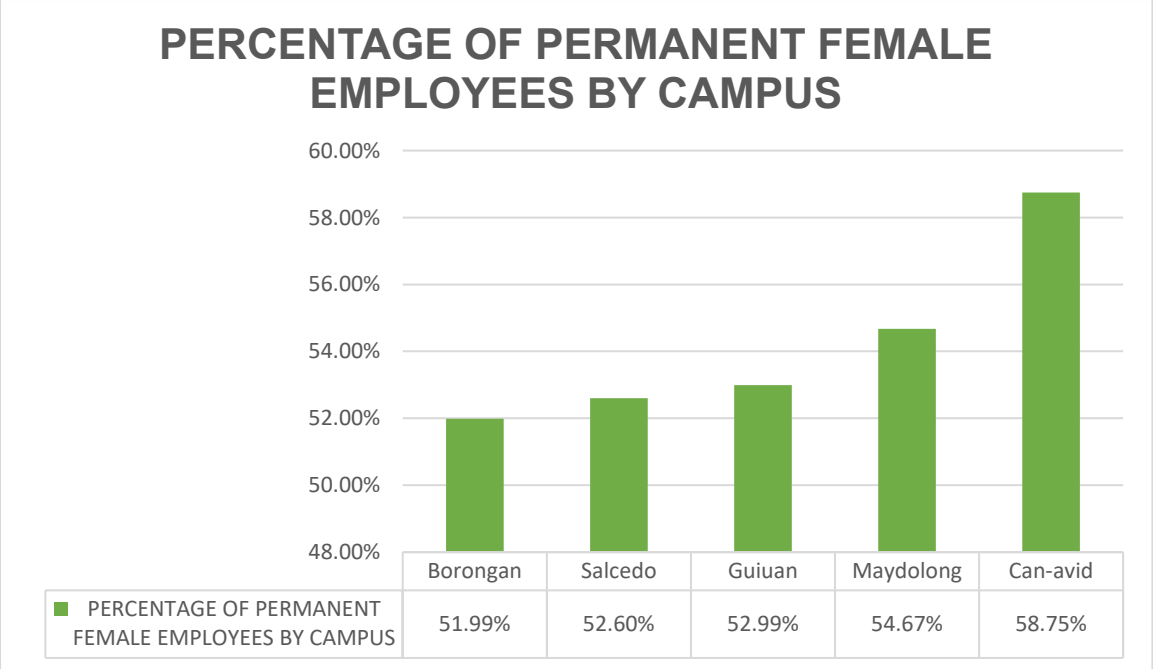
The following table summarizes the permanent personnel figures supplied for each campus.

Campus	Male	Female	Total	Male %	Female %
Main	217	235	452	48.01%	51.99%
Salcedo	73	81	154	47.40%	52.60%
Guiuan	63	71	134	47.01%	52.99%
Maydolong	34	41	75	45.33%	54.67%
Can-avid	33	47	80	41.25%	58.75%
ESSU Total	**420**	**475**	**895**	**46.93%**	**53.07%**

II. Graphical Presentation







III. Interpretation of the results

The data indicate that female personnel account for a majority of ESSU's permanent workforce, with 475 employees or 53.07%, compared with 420 male employees or 46.93%. This represents a difference of 55 employees in favor of women.

The campus-level distribution shows that female personnel outnumber male personnel in all five campuses. Can-avid has the highest female representation at 58.75%, while the Main Campus has the lowest proportion at 51.99%. The differences across campuses are useful for institutional monitoring, but they should not be interpreted as evidence of unequal compensation.

8.2.8 Employment Practice Appeal Process

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes that good employment practices require not only fair compensation and equitable employment conditions but also accessible and responsive mechanisms through which employees can raise concerns, seek redress, and appeal decisions affecting their employment rights and welfare. In support of Sustainable Development Goal 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth, the University has institutionalized a formal grievance and appeal mechanism that provides employees with an established process for addressing workplace-related concerns, including matters involving salaries, incentives, working hours, leave benefits, recruitment, promotion, and other conditions of employment.

ESSU's commitment to providing employees with an accessible process for seeking redress is demonstrated through its **HR Mechanism for Grievance Machinery**, which was approved by the Civil Service Commission (CSC) Regional Office VIII on November 23, 2021. In its official communication addressed to the University President, the CSC Regional Office VIII confirmed that it had approved the University's customized HR Mechanism for Grievance Machinery. The approval recognizes the University's institutionalized procedures for handling employee grievances and establishes an approved mechanism for resolving workplace-related concerns in accordance with applicable Civil Service Commission policies.

The Grievance Machinery was adopted in accordance with the Revised Policies on the Settlement of Grievance in the Public Sector under CSC Resolution No. 010113 dated January 10, 2001, implemented through CSC Memorandum Circular No. 02, series of 2001. It establishes the procedures, responsibilities, and institutional arrangements for receiving, processing, investigating, and resolving grievances involving government officials and employees.

Institutional Policy and Coverage of Employee Appeals

The ESSU Grievance Machinery applies to all levels of officials and employees in the University and may also apply to non-career employees whenever applicable. It provides an institutional process for addressing work-related discontentment or dissatisfaction expressed verbally or in writing when the employee believes that the concern has been ignored or not given due consideration.

The policy expressly recognizes employment-related grievances involving economic and financial issues and other terms and conditions of employment. Under Section V, Application of Grievance Machinery, the following concerns shall be acted upon through the grievance machinery:

- Non-implementation of policies, practices, and procedures on economic and financial issues and other terms and conditions of employment fixed by law, including salaries, incentives, working hours, and leave benefits;
- Delay in the processing of overtime pay, unreasonable withholding of salaries, and inaction on applications for leave;
- Non-implementation of policies, practices, and procedures affecting employees from recruitment to promotion, detail, transfer, retirement, termination, and lay-offs;
- Failure to observe the selection process in appointments and undue delay in the processing of retirement papers;
- Inadequate physical working conditions, including insufficient facilities and equipment necessary for employee safety and protection; and
- Poor interpersonal relationships and other matters giving rise to employee dissatisfaction and discontentment.

These provisions directly demonstrate the relevance of the Grievance Machinery to the THE Sustainability Impact Ratings 2027 requirement under Metric 8.2.8, which calls for universities to **"Have a process for employees to appeal on employee rights and/or pay."** By expressly covering salary-related concerns, incentives, working hours, leave benefits, and other employment conditions, ESSU provides employees with a formal avenue for seeking redress when their rights or employment entitlements are not properly implemented.

Established Procedures for Filing and Appealing Grievances

The Grievance Machinery establishes a step-by-step procedure for resolving employee concerns, beginning at the lowest organizational level and progressing through the appropriate supervisory and institutional authorities when the grievance remains unresolved.

Under Section VI, Grievance Procedures, an employee may initially present a grievance verbally or in writing to the immediate supervisor. The supervisor is required to inform the aggrieved party of the corresponding action within three (3) working days from the date the grievance is presented.

If the employee is dissatisfied with the action taken, the grievance may be elevated to the next higher supervisor within five (5) days. The next higher supervisor must render a

decision within five (5) working days from receipt of the grievance. If the employee remains dissatisfied, the matter may be elevated to the Grievance Committee within five (5) working days from receipt of the supervisor's decision.

The Grievance Committee may conduct an investigation and hearing within ten (10) working days from receipt of the grievance and is required to render a decision within five (5) working days after the investigation. If the aggrieved party is not satisfied with the committee's decision, the grievance may be elevated through the committee to top management within five (5) working days from receipt of the decision. Top management is required to decide within ten (10) working days after receipt of the grievance.

Finally, if the employee remains dissatisfied with the decision of top management, the grievance may be appealed or elevated to the Civil Service Commission Regional Office concerned within fifteen (15) working days from receipt of the decision, together with the Certification on the Final Action on the Grievance (CFAG).

This structured procedure ensures that employees are provided with successive opportunities to seek resolution and appeal decisions through clearly identified institutional authorities. It also establishes specific periods for action and decision-making, promoting timely resolution and accountability in the handling of employee concerns.

Employee Protection and Assurance of Fair Treatment

A significant feature of the ESSU Grievance Machinery is its explicit protection of employees who seek redress. Section I, Basic Policies, provides:

"The aggrieved party shall be assured freedom from coercion, discrimination, reprisal and biased action on the grievance."

This provision is particularly important in establishing a workplace environment where employees can raise concerns without fear of retaliation, intimidation, or discriminatory treatment. It reinforces the University's commitment to fair and impartial grievance handling and encourages employees to use established institutional procedures when their rights or employment conditions are affected.

The policy also provides that grievances shall be resolved expeditiously at the lowest level possible within the agency. However, when a grievance cannot be settled at that level, the aggrieved party may present the matter step by step following the hierarchy of positions. It further allows grievances to be presented verbally or in writing, making the mechanism accessible to employees without requiring complex legal procedures.

The Grievance Machinery also provides accountability for supervisors and officials who fail to act on grievances brought to their attention. It states that supervisors or officials who refuse to take action may be held liable for neglect of duty in accordance with existing Civil Service laws, rules, and regulations. This provision strengthens institutional accountability and reinforces the responsibility of University officials to respond appropriately to employee concerns.

Institutional Grievance Committee and Administrative Accountability

To ensure the effective implementation of the Grievance Machinery, ESSU provides for the establishment of separate Grievance Committees in the Main Campus and external campuses. The committee composition includes representatives from human resource management, division chiefs, rank-and-file employees from the first and second levels, and the designated Bilis Aksyon Partner.

The policy further provides that the University President shall ensure equal opportunity for men and women to be represented in the Grievance Committee. In selecting or appointing committee members, consideration shall be given to their integrity, probity, sincerity, and credibility.

The Grievance Committee is responsible not only for resolving specific employee concerns but also for implementing preventive and developmental measures. These include conducting employee assemblies at least once every quarter, facilitating discussions and counseling, conducting information campaigns on the Grievance Machinery, facilitating dialogue between parties, documenting grievances and agreements, and submitting quarterly accomplishment reports and the status of unresolved grievances to the CSC Regional Office concerned.

These responsibilities demonstrate that ESSU's grievance mechanism goes beyond a reactive process for addressing complaints. It also serves as a preventive and participatory institutional mechanism that promotes constructive employee relations, improved employee morale, and a workplace environment characterized by communication, accountability, and respect for employee rights.

Impact on Employment Practices and Employee Welfare

The implementation of the approved Grievance Machinery contributes to the University's commitment to decent work by providing employees with a formal and accessible process for addressing employment-related concerns. Its impact may be understood through several institutional dimensions.

First, it **strengthens the protection of employee rights and employment entitlements** by explicitly covering grievances involving salaries, incentives, working hours, leave benefits, and other terms and conditions of employment. Employees therefore have an established institutional avenue to raise concerns regarding the implementation of policies affecting their compensation and employment welfare.

Second, it **promotes procedural fairness and accountability** by establishing successive levels of review, defined responsibilities, and prescribed periods for responding to and resolving grievances. The process ensures that employee concerns are not left solely to the discretion of an immediate supervisor and provides opportunities for further review by higher authorities, the Grievance Committee, top management, and ultimately the CSC Regional Office.

Third, it **protects employees against coercion, discrimination, reprisal, and biased action** when seeking redress. This safeguard supports a more inclusive and respectful working environment where employees can communicate concerns without fear of retaliation.

Fourth, it **strengthens institutional communication and employee participation** through the establishment of Grievance Committees, periodic employee assemblies, dialogue, counseling, and continuing information campaigns. These activities help address workplace concerns before they develop into more serious organizational conflicts.

Finally, it **promotes continuous institutional monitoring and improvement** through the documentation of grievances, issuance of Certifications on the Final Action on the Grievance, and submission of quarterly reports on committee accomplishments and unresolved cases to the CSC Regional Office. These requirements provide a basis for monitoring the University's responsiveness and identifying recurring employment concerns that may require policy or administrative intervention.

Contribution to SDG 8 and Institutional Commitment

The ESSU Grievance Machinery demonstrates the University's commitment to good employment practices through the institutionalization of a formal process for employees to appeal on employee rights and/or pay. Its coverage of salary-related concerns, employment conditions, recruitment, promotion, and other workplace issues directly supports the intent of THE Sustainability Impact Ratings 2027 under Metric 8.2.8.

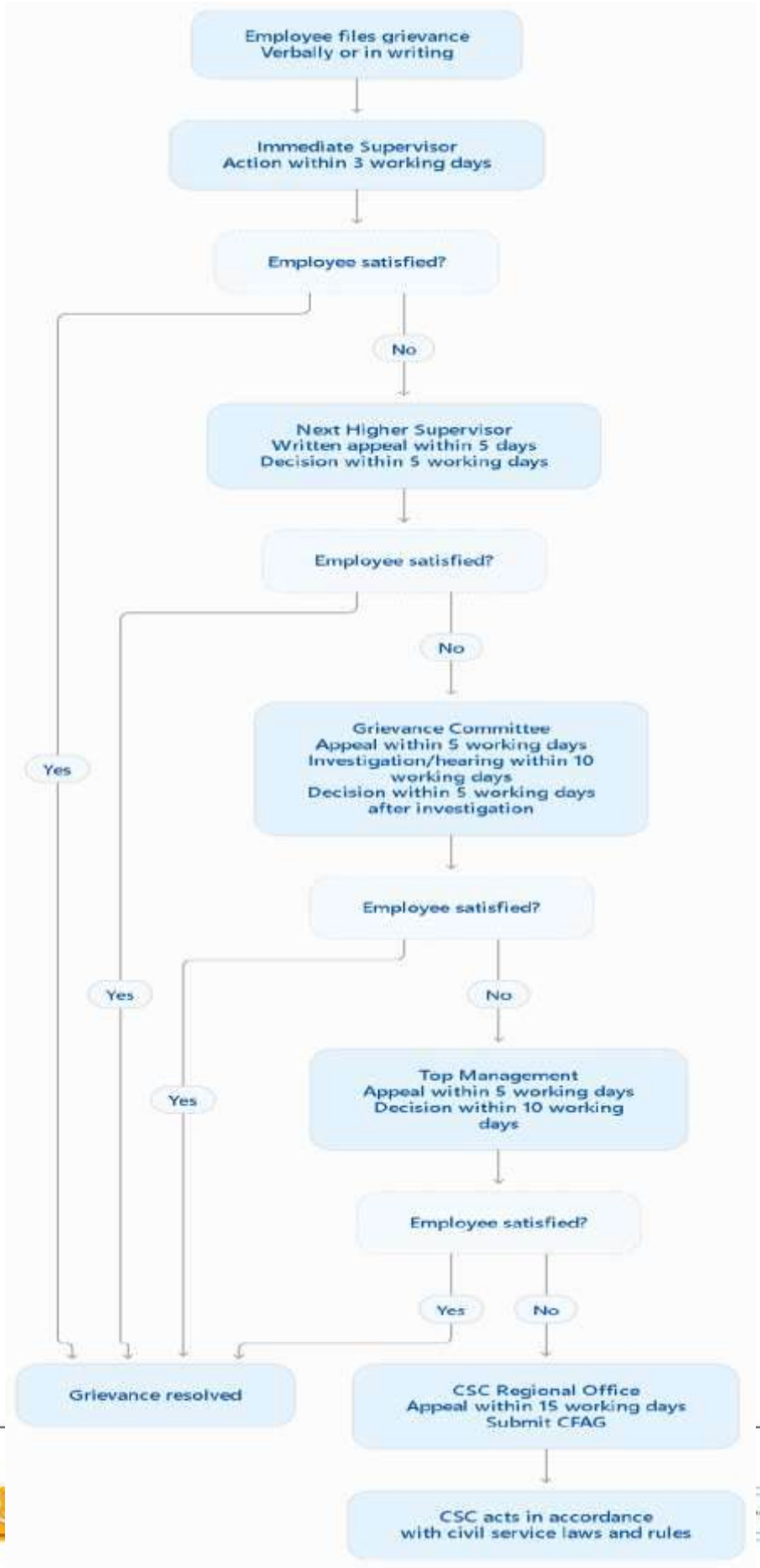
The mechanism also contributes to the objectives of SDG Target 8.5 by supporting fair employment conditions and the protection of employees' economic and workplace entitlements. Its provisions on freedom from coercion, discrimination, reprisal, and biased action further reinforce the principles of safe, inclusive, and equitable working environments.

Through the CSC-approved HR Mechanism for Grievance Machinery, ESSU demonstrates that employee concerns are addressed through established institutional procedures rather than informal or arbitrary arrangements. The mechanism provides a formal avenue for employees to seek redress, promotes accountability among supervisors and University officials, and strengthens the University's commitment to employee welfare and institutional integrity.

By maintaining and implementing this approved mechanism, Eastern Samar State University affirms that the protection of employee rights, fair treatment, and accessible appeal procedures are integral components of its employment practices and its broader commitment to decent work and sustainable institutional development.

Link to Evidence: Grievance Machinery / HR policies

Representation of the Appeal Process



8.2.9 Employment Practice: Labour Rights

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes and upholds employees' fundamental labor rights, particularly freedom of association and collective bargaining, as essential elements of fair, inclusive, and equitable employment practices. The University respects the right of all employees, regardless of gender or employment status, to organize, participate in employee associations, and engage in collective negotiations without discrimination or reprisal.

ESSU demonstrates this commitment through its partnership with the ESSU Employees Union (ESSU-EU) and the implementation of its Collective Negotiation Agreement (CNA), registered with the Civil Service Commission on May 6, 2024, under Certificate of Registration No. 309. Through these mechanisms, the University promotes constructive labor-management relations, employee representation, and the protection of workers' rights and welfare. These initiatives reflect ESSU's commitment to a workplace founded on mutual respect, social dialogue, and equal opportunities for all employees, including women and international staff, consistent with applicable laws and regulations.

ESSU Employees Union registration and recognition documents.

Collective Negotiation Agreement and its Civil Service Commission registration.

Union election records and list of officers.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

8.3 Expenditure per employee



8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

Reporting Period: Calendar Year 2025

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes that institutional expenditure plays an important role in sustaining employment, supporting university operations, and contributing to the economic development of the communities it serves. Through the allocation of financial resources across its five campuses, the University supports its workforce and maintains the delivery of academic and administrative services.

For Calendar Year 2025, ESSU assessed its expenditure per employee by dividing the university expenditure by the number of employees. The resulting amount was then normalised against the regional economic benchmark to provide a measure of the **relative value to the region in which the university is situated that is independent of institution size**, consistent with the measurement approach described in the Times Higher Education Sustainability Impact Ratings methodology.

Based on the University's consolidated records, ESSU recorded a total expenditure of **PHP 948,395,482.83**, supporting 1,333 Job Order, Contract of Service, and Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) personnel across its Borongan, Can-avid, Maydolong, Salcedo, and Guiuan campuses. This translates to a consolidated expenditure per employee of **PHP 711,474.48.**

The distribution of expenditure per employee varies across campuses. Borongan recorded the highest amount at PHP 882,363.37, followed by Guiuan at PHP 643,243.53, Salcedo at PHP 553,788.65, Can-avid at PHP 515,949.84, and Maydolong at PHP 465,157.65. These differences illustrate the varying levels of institutional expenditure relative to workforce size across the University's geographically dispersed campuses.

For the regional comparison, ESSU utilized the **2025 Per Capita Gross Regional Domestic Expenditure (GRDE) of Eastern Visayas amounting to PHP 137,209.00**, based on the Philippine Statistics Authority's Regional Accounts of the Philippines, Table 2.1, at current prices. The regional benchmark provides an economic reference for assessing the University's expenditure within the context of the region where it operates.

Using this benchmark, ESSU obtained a normalized expenditure-per-employee value of **5.19.** This indicates that the University's expenditure per employee is approximately 5.19 times the reported per capita GRDE of Eastern Visayas. The result demonstrates the relative

scale of the University's institutional expenditure compared with the regional economic benchmark.

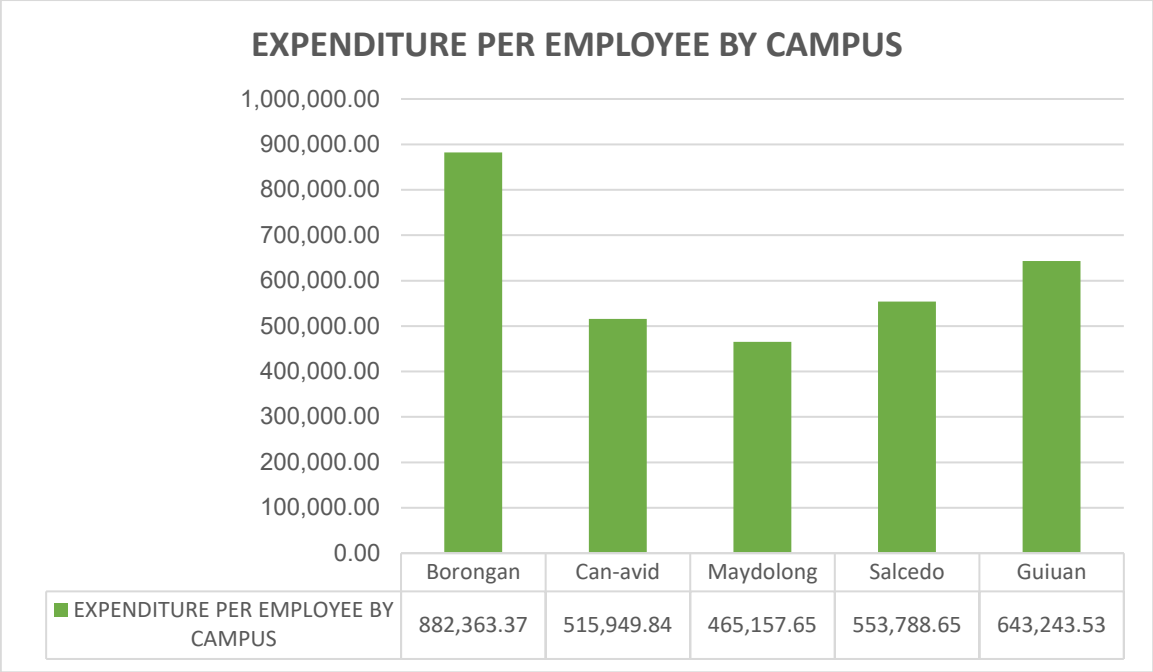
These figures highlight ESSU's economic presence through the financial resources it mobilizes to sustain its workforce and institutional operations. With campuses serving different localities in Eastern Samar, the University's expenditures contribute to economic activity within its host communities while supporting the continued delivery of accessible higher education.

In relation to **SDG 8**, the indicator provides evidence of the University's economic contribution and resource utilization. It supports the broader objectives of Target 8.1 on sustained, inclusive and sustainable economic growth and Target 8.4 on improving global resource efficiency in consumption and production. By examining expenditure relative to workforce size and the regional economic benchmark, ESSU demonstrates its role as a public higher education institution contributing to regional economic activity and sustainable institutional operations.

I. Consolidated Institutional Data

Indicator	Calendar Year 2025
Number of employees	1,333
University expenditure	PHP 948,395,482.83
Expenditure per employee	PHP 711,474.48
Eastern Visayas per capita GRDE	PHP 137,209.00
Normalized expenditure per employee	**5.19**

II. Expenditure per Employee by Campus



The graph illustrates the differences in expenditure per employee across ESSU's five campuses. Borongan has the highest expenditure per employee, while Maydolong has the lowest. These figures provide a comparative view of institutional expenditure relative to the number of personnel supported at each campus.

III. Detailed Campus-level Expenditure

Campus	Employees	University expenditure (PHP)	Expenditure per employee (PHP)
Borongan	620	547,065,289.06	882,363.37
Can-avid	141	72,748,927.09	515,949.84
Maydolong	116	53,958,287.87	465,157.65
Salcedo	209	115,741,827.35	553,788.65
Guiuan	247	158,881,151.46	643,243.53
Consolidated	**1,333**	**948,395,482.83**	**711,474.48**

IV. Regional Economic Benchmark

PHILIPPINE STATISTICS AUTHORITY · CALENDAR YEAR 2025

PHP 137,209.00

Per Capita Gross Regional Domestic Expenditure – Eastern Visayas
At current prices · Regional Accounts of the Philippines · Table 2.1 · As of April 2026
Source document: PSA Eastern Visayas – Per Capita GRDE, 2025 (PDF)

V. Implications for Sustainable Economic Development

The CY 2025 results offer three important observations:

1. Institutional economic contribution. ESSU's PHP 948.40 million expenditure reflects the substantial financial resources mobilized to sustain its workforce and institutional operations. These expenditures help maintain educational services and support economic activity in the communities where its campuses are situated.

2. Resource allocation across campuses. The differences in expenditure per employee demonstrate the varying levels of institutional resource utilization across the five campuses. This information provides a basis for evaluating campus-level expenditure patterns and improving resource allocation in support of sustainable operations.

3. Regional economic relevance. The normalized value of 5.19 provides a comparative indication of ESSU's expenditure per employee relative to the Eastern Visayas regional economic benchmark. It highlights the scale of institutional spending in relation to the region's per capita economic expenditure.

Through these contributions, ESSU reinforces the role of public higher education institutions in supporting employment, sustaining institutional services, and contributing to inclusive and sustainable regional economic development.

EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

8.4 Proportion of students taking work placements



8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

Reporting Period: Academic Year 2024 - 2025

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes the importance of integrating practical workplace experiences into academic programs to prepare students for the demands of the labor market. Through required on-the-job training (OJT), internships, and other employment placements embedded in students' academic requirements, the University provides opportunities for learners to apply theoretical knowledge, develop professional competencies, and gain firsthand experience in actual workplace environments.

In accordance with the Times Higher Education (THE) Sustainability Impact Ratings methodology, this indicator measures the **"number of students with an employment placement of more than a month required as part of their studies, divided by the total number of students. All data are provided as fulltime equivalents."** It relates to UN Sustainable Development Goal 8, Target 8.6, which emphasizes reducing the proportion of youth not in employment, education, or training.

For Academic Year 2024–2025, ESSU recorded an average student population of **24,994** across its five campuses. Of this number, **5,323** students participated in qualifying work placements lasting more than one month, representing a consolidated proportion **of 0.213 or 21.30%** of the University's student population.

The results demonstrate ESSU's continuing efforts to integrate workplace exposure into higher education and strengthen the connection between academic learning and professional practice. These placements allow students to develop technical skills, workplace adaptability, professional discipline, communication, and problem-solving abilities that are essential for successful participation in the labor market.

Campus-level Performance and Institutional Impact

Among the five campuses, Salcedo recorded the highest proportion of students with work placements at **0.230 (23.02%),** followed by Can-avid at **0.217 (21.70%)** and Borongan at **0.215 (21.51%).** Maydolong registered **0.433 (43.35%),** while Guiuan recorded **0.146 (14.61%).**

Maydolong's result indicates a particularly strong level of student participation in qualifying work placements relative to its average student population. This suggests the importance of sustained industry and community linkages in providing students with opportunities for practical learning. Meanwhile, the results from Borongan, Can-avid, and

Salcedo reflect relatively comparable levels of participation, indicating the integration of workplace learning across multiple campuses.

Although Guiuan recorded the lowest proportion, its 850 students with qualifying work placements demonstrate that workplace exposure is also being extended to students in the University's geographically distinct campus. The differences across campuses provide a useful basis for assessing placement opportunities, strengthening partnerships with employers and host institutions, and identifying areas where access to practical training can be further expanded.

Contribution to SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth

The University's work placement initiatives contribute to SDG 8 by strengthening students' preparation for employment and facilitating the transition from education to the world of work. By requiring students to undertake supervised workplace experiences as part of their academic programs, ESSU helps bridge the gap between classroom instruction and actual professional responsibilities.

Beyond the acquisition of technical competencies, these experiences expose students to organizational procedures, professional expectations, workplace collaboration, and the practical application of their respective fields of study. Such exposure supports the development of a more work-ready graduate population and strengthens the University's responsiveness to evolving labor market requirements.

Overall, the consolidated participation rate of **21.30%** reflects ESSU's contribution to employment-oriented education through structured and curriculum-integrated work placements. Moving forward, the University can build on these accomplishments by expanding partnerships with industries, government institutions, and other host organizations to increase access to meaningful workplace experiences across all campuses.

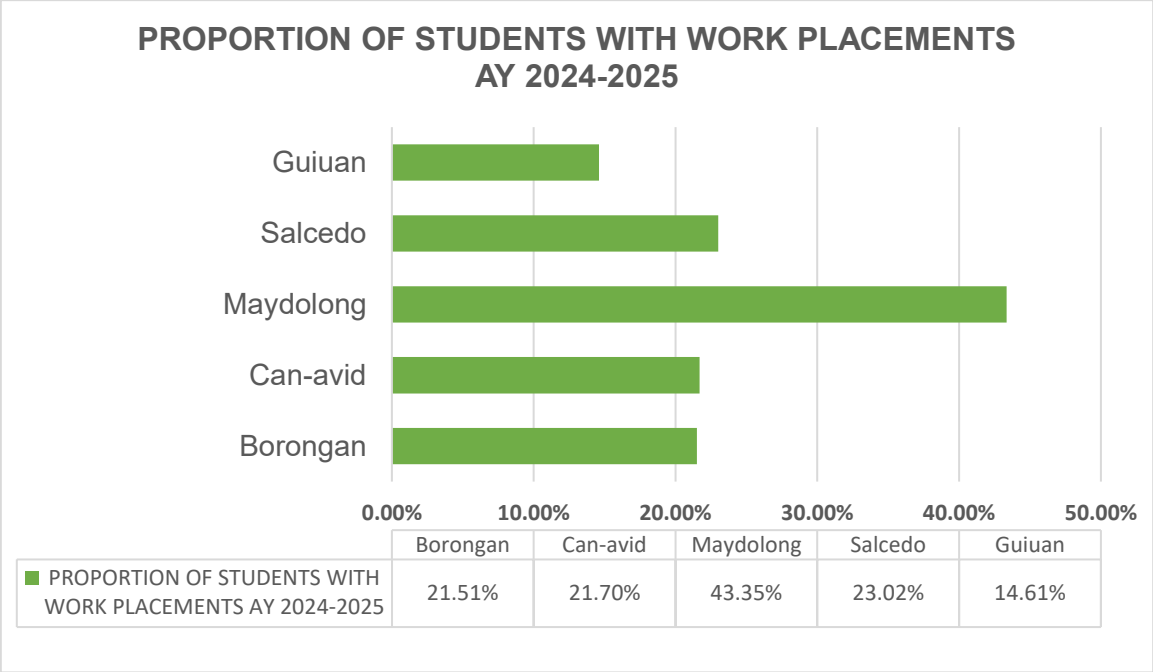
I. Comparative Campus Performance

The following table presents the average student population, the number of students with qualifying work placements, and the corresponding proportion for each campus.

Campus	Average No. of Students	Students with Work Placements	Proportion	Percentage
Borongan	11,922	2,564	0.215	21.51%
Can-avid	3,470	753	0.217	21.70%

Maydolong	1,398	606	0.433	43.35%
Salcedo	2,389	550	0.230	23.02%
Guiuan	5,816	850	0.146	14.61%
Consolidated	**24,994**	**5,323**	**0.213**	**21.30%**

II. Graphical Presentation of Results



The campus comparison shows that Maydolong has the highest relative participation, with approximately 43 out of every 100 students undertaking qualifying work placements. The other campuses recorded proportions ranging from approximately 15% to 23%. This variation highlights opportunities for institutional learning and the sharing of effective placement arrangements across campuses.

III. Summary of Institutional Contribution

21.30%
Consolidated proportion of students with qualifying work placements

5,323
Students with work placements

24,994
Average student population

THE SDG 8.4 indicator · Academic Year 2024–2025

ESSU's performance under this indicator demonstrates the University's commitment to preparing students for the world of work through curriculum-integrated employment placements. The participation of 5,323 students across its campuses illustrates the University's efforts to provide practical learning opportunities that complement classroom instruction and strengthen employability-related competencies.

These initiatives support the broader objectives of SDG 8 by helping equip students with relevant workplace experience before graduation. Continued expansion of industry partnerships, placement opportunities, and institutional coordination can further strengthen this contribution and promote more equitable access to workplace learning across the University's campuses.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

8.5 Proportion of employees on secure contracts



8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

Reporting Period: Calendar Year 2025

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes the importance of employment security in promoting decent work, workforce stability, and institutional sustainability. Providing employees with relatively secure employment arrangements contributes to organizational continuity, strengthens institutional capacity, and supports the retention of personnel who play essential roles in delivering quality education and public service.

In assessing this indicator, the University considered the **number of employees (both academic and non-academic) on contracts of more than 24 months,** divided by the total number of employees. Consistent with the Times Higher Education methodology, the assessment covers employees on contracts exceeding 24 months and explicitly excludes short-term contracts required to cover for maternity or paternity leave. The figures are presented based on the University's reported employee counts for Calendar Year 2025.

For the reporting period, ESSU recorded **178 employees on contracts of more than 24 months out of a total workforce of 1,333,** representing a consolidated proportion of **0.134 or 13.35%.** These employees consisted of 119 personnel under Job Order (JO) arrangements and 59 under Contract of Service (COS) – Teaching arrangements, as reflected in the University's submitted data.

The campus-level results show variations in the proportion of employees on secure contracts. Maydolong Campus recorded the highest proportion at **0.207 (20.69%),** followed by Guiuan Campus at **0.186 (18.62%)** and Can-avid Campus at **0.184 (18.44%).** Salcedo Campus registered **0.105 (10.53%),** while Borongan Campus recorded **0.097 (9.68%).**

These results demonstrate differences in the distribution of employees on contracts exceeding 24 months across the University's campuses. Maydolong, Guiuan, and Can-avid have comparatively higher proportions, indicating a greater representation of employees meeting the methodology's contract-duration criterion relative to their respective workforces. Meanwhile, the lower proportions in Borongan and Salcedo highlight opportunities for the University to further examine employment arrangements and workforce planning across its campuses.

From an institutional sustainability perspective, employment security is important in maintaining a stable workforce, supporting the continuity of academic and administrative functions, and strengthening the University's capacity to deliver its educational and community-service commitments. Employees who remain in the institution over longer contractual periods can contribute to the retention of institutional knowledge, sustained

program implementation, and more consistent delivery of services to students and communities.

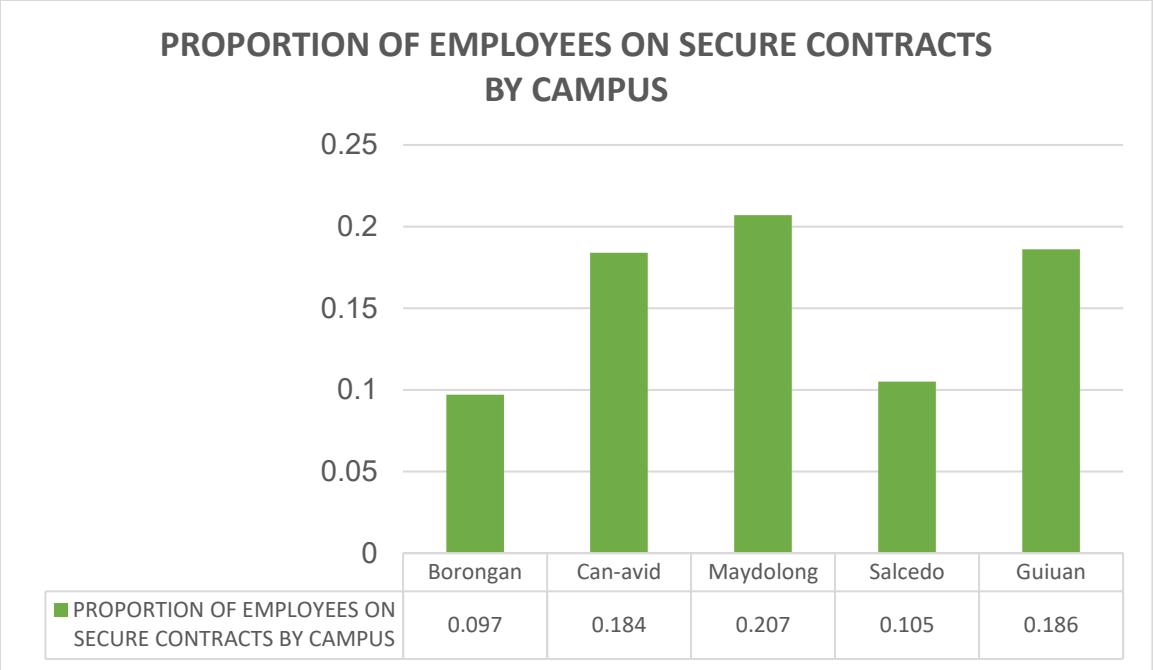
Overall, the results provide ESSU with a baseline for monitoring the proportion of its workforce employed under contracts of more than 24 months. They also underscore the importance of strengthening workforce planning and reviewing employment arrangements across campuses to support greater employment stability and contribute to **Sustainable Development Goal 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth,** particularly Target 8.5, which promotes full and productive employment and decent work for all.

I. Campus-level Distribution of Employees on Secure Contracts

The following table presents the proportion of employees on contracts of more than 24 months relative to the total number of employees in each ESSU campus.

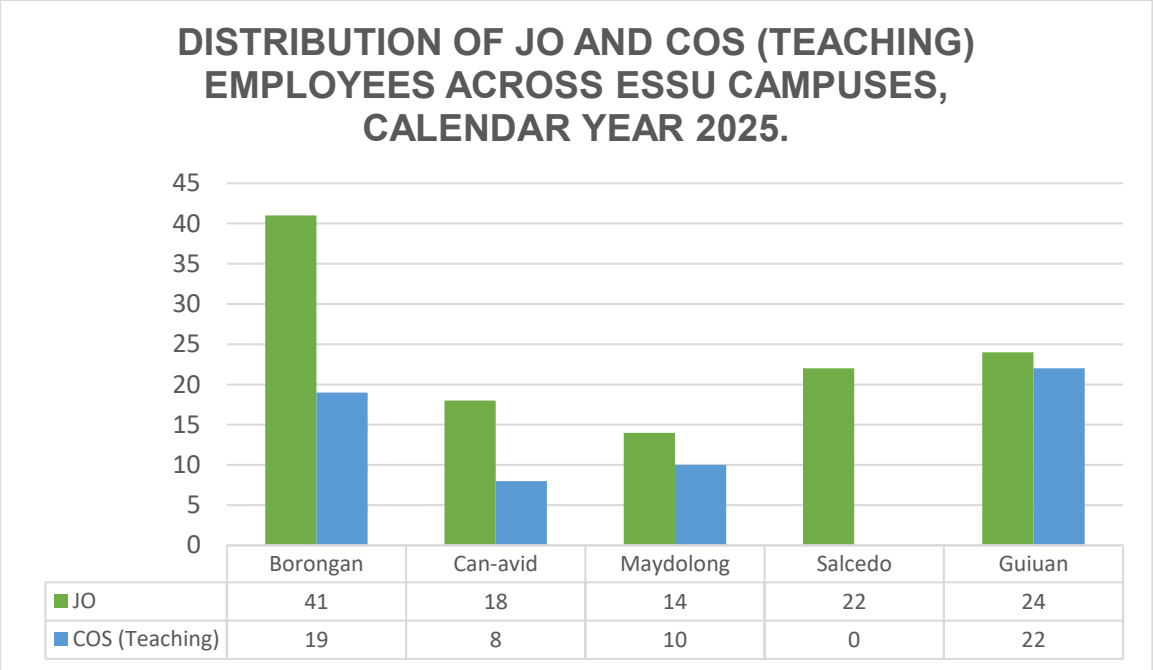
Campus	Employees on contracts >24 months	Total employees	Proportion	Percentage
Borongan	60	620	0.097	9.68%
Can-avid	26	141	0.184	18.44%
Maydolong	24	116	0.207	20.69%
Salcedo	22	209	0.105	10.53%
Guiuan	46	247	0.186	18.62%
Consolidated	**178**	**1,333**	**0.134**	**13.35%**

II. Graphical Presentation of Campus-level Proportions



Maydolong Campus leads in the proportion of employees on contracts exceeding 24 months, with approximately one in five employees meeting the criterion. In contrast, Borongan Campus has the lowest proportion. The consolidated university figure of 13.35% provides an overall baseline for assessing employment security across ESSU.

III. Distribution of Employees on Contracts of more than 24 Months



	Borongan	Can-avid	Maydolong	Salcedo	Guiuan
JO	41	18	14	22	24
COS (Teaching)	19	8	10	0	22

The distribution indicates that Job Order personnel account for 119 of the 178 employees reported under contracts exceeding 24 months, representing approximately 66.85%. Meanwhile, COS (Teaching) personnel account for 59 employees or 33.15%.